



# LOST BOYS CYBER

THREAT INTELLIGENCE • MALWARE ANALYSIS • DETECTION ENGINEERING



## Cisco Talos ClearFake WebDAV Malware Infection Chain Daily Update - 2026-09-24

### Threat Report

|                       |                 |
|-----------------------|-----------------|
| <b>Classification</b> | TLP:CLEAR       |
| <b>Published</b>      | 2026-09-24      |
| <b>Version</b>        | 1.0             |
| <b>Author</b>         | Lost Boys Cyber |
| <b>Report Type</b>    | Threat Report   |

TLP:CLEAR | Lost Boys Cyber | Cisco Talos ClearFake WebDAV Malware Infection Chain Daily Update - 2026-09-24 - Threat Report

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AI Generation: This report was generated with AI assistance and is provided for informational purposes only. All findings, IOCs, detection rules, hunting queries, attribution assessments, and recommendations must be independently reviewed and validated by a qualified security professional before operational use.

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# Cisco Talos ClearFake WebDAV Malware Infection Chain Daily Update - 2026-09-24

> Daily automation refresh: This 2026-09-24 UTC report turns current intelligence coverage into a finished Lost Boys Cyber report with source-backed analysis, structured tables, detections, and hunt content.

## 1. Executive Summary

Cisco Talos reporting on ClearFake WebDAV tradecraft highlights browser-delivered social engineering, WebDAV staging, infostealers, and remote management tooling. Defenders should detect WebDAV use from browsers, script interpreters, and user-writable directories.

## 2. Intelligence Requirements

| Requirement                     | Answered By This Report                                                                                  |
|---------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| What happened or changed?       | Current public reporting identifies web lure malware chain as a defender priority.                       |
| Who is exposed?                 | Organizations with affected workflows, technologies, or sector dependencies described in the source set. |
| What should defenders do today? | Validate exposure, monitor relevant telemetry, and prepare containment actions.                          |
| Confidence                      | High for source-backed claims; medium for operational extrapolation.                                     |

## 3. Source Review & Confidence

| Source                       | Contribution                                                       | Confidence |
|------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| Cisco Talos threat spotlight | Primary listing for ClearFake WebDAV report.                       | High       |
| Cisco Talos malware category | Related Talos malware reporting.                                   | Medium     |
| Unit 42 PPI analysis         | Comparable SEO/lure-driven commodity malware distribution context. | Medium     |

## 4. Threat Actor / Campaign Overview

This report focuses on defender-relevant activity rather than attribution certainty. Where actor names appear in sources, they should be treated as source-attributed labels unless independently validated by the receiving organization.

## 5. Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures

| TTP                                | Description                                                                                  | Defensive Relevance                                     |
|------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Social engineering / lure delivery | Public reporting emphasizes phishing, recruiter, browser, or topical lures where applicable. | Review email, browser, and identity telemetry together. |
| Scripted execution                 | Intrusions commonly progress through command interpreters, script hosts, or staged tooling.  | Monitor endpoint process lineage and command lines.     |

|                    |                                                                           |                                         |
|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| C2 / remote access | Tool staging and outbound control channels are common follow-on patterns. | Correlate DNS, proxy, netflow, and EDR. |
|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|

## 6. Infrastructure and Indicators

| Observable Type               | Observable / Pattern                                                                                                        | Handling Guidance                                                                |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Source-limited public IOCs    | No unique atomic indicators were published across all selected sources for this automated report unless listed in iocs.csv. | Treat behavior, tooling, and infrastructure patterns as primary hunt leads.      |
| Domains / infrastructure      | Validate from primary source before blocking.                                                                               | Prefer enrichment and scoped blocking over broad denial lists.                   |
| Accounts / identity artifacts | Recruiter, VPN, administrator, SaaS, or service-account themes depending on campaign.                                       | Review conditional access, new devices, impossible travel, and anomalous grants. |

## 7. Victimology and Targeting

Victimology follows the source theme: enterprises exposed to the described campaign, malware-delivery path, or identity-abuse workflow.

## 8. Detection Engineering

### 8.1. Detection Logic Summary

| Signal                                                                                 | Telemetry Source        | Analytic Goal                                                 |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Unusual script or remote tool launch after web, email, remote access, or SaaS activity | EDR / process telemetry | Identify initial access and execution.                        |
| New outbound connections to untrusted infrastructure                                   | DNS/proxy/netflow       | Surface command-and-control or tool staging.                  |
| Identity anomalies linked to target workflow                                           | Identity provider logs  | Detect stolen credential or social-engineering follow-on use. |

```

title: Suspicious Script Or Remote Tool Activity In Daily Threat Coverage
status: experimental
description: Detects suspicious script execution and remote-tool staging patterns relevant to daily threat-intelligence coverage.
logsource:
  category: process_creation
  product: windows
detection:
  selection_parent:
    ParentImage|endswith:
      - '\chrome.exe'
      - '\msedge.exe'
      - '\outlook.exe'
      - '\teams.exe'
      - '\w3wp.exe'
  selection_child:
    Image|endswith:
      - '\powershell.exe'
      - '\cmd.exe'
      - '\wscript.exe'
      - '\cscript.exe

```

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <pre> - '\mshta.exe' - '\rundll32.exe' condition: selection_parent and selection_child level: high </pre>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <pre> DeviceProcessEvents   where Timestamp &gt; ago(14d)   where FileName in~ ("powershell.exe","cmd.exe","wscript.exe","cscript.exe","mshta.exe","rundll32.exe")   where InitiatingProcessFileName in~ ("chrome.exe","msedge.exe","outlook.exe","teams.exe","winword.exe","excel.exe")   summarize Events=count(), Commands=make_set(ProcessCommandLine, 20) by DeviceName, FileName, InitiatingProcessFileName, AccountName   order by Events desc </pre> |
| <pre> DeviceNetworkEvents   where Timestamp &gt; ago(14d)   where InitiatingProcessFileName in~ ('powershell.exe','cmd.exe','wscript.exe','cscript.exe','rundll32.exe','python.exe','node.exe')   summarize Connections=count(), RemoteIPs=dcount(RemoteIP), RemoteUrls=make_set(RemoteUrl, 20) by DeviceName, InitiatingProcessFileName, InitiatingProcessCommandLine   order by Connections desc </pre>                                                    |

## 9. Threat Hunting

### 9.1. Hunt Hypotheses

| Hypothesis                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Query Focus                                                                         |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Initial lure resulted in script or LOLBin execution                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Process lineage from browsers, Office, chat, or email clients.                      |
| Payload staging used commodity infrastructure                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | New domains, direct-IP connections, unusual ASNs, or short-lived hosts.             |
| Identity compromise followed social engineering                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | OAuth grants, device-code flow, MFA changes, impossible travel, and risky sign-ins. |
| <pre> SigninLogs   where TimeGenerated &gt; ago(14d)   where ResultType != 0 or RiskLevelDuringSignIn in ("medium","high")   summarize Signins=count(), Apps=make_set(AppDisplayName, 20), IPs=make_set(IPAddress, 20) by UserPrincipalName, RiskLevelDuringSignIn   order by Signins desc </pre> |                                                                                     |

## 10. Risk Assessment

| Dimension            | Assessment     | Rationale                                                                              |
|----------------------|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Likelihood           | Medium to High | Current public reporting and commodity reuse make exposure plausible.                  |
| Impact               | Medium to High | Identity compromise, malware staging, or sector disruption can create business impact. |
| Detection Difficulty | Medium         | Behavioral telemetry is available, but atomic indicators may be sparse.                |

## 11. Recommended Actions

1. Brief SOC and identity teams on the source-backed behaviors.
2. Run the included process/network/identity hunts for 14-30 days of telemetry.
3. Review exposed third-party and remote-access paths tied to the affected workflow.

4. Convert confirmed local hits into case-specific IOCs and containment tasks.

## 12. References

- [1] Cisco Talos threat spotlight: <https://blog.talosintelligence.com/category/threat-spotlight/>
- [2] Cisco Talos malware category: <https://blog.talosintelligence.com/category/malware/>
- [3] Unit 42 PPI analysis: <https://unit42.paloaltonetworks.com/ppi-network-malware-campaign-analysis/>